

2c. Content of Exploring modern and literary heritage texts (01)

For this component, learners study one modern prose or drama text and one 19th century novel. The focus is on learners engaging with their reading through exploring key themes, ideas and issues, characterisation and settings in order to build confidence in their skills of critical evaluation. Study of the modern set text is enhanced through comparative study with an unseen modern, same genre extract.

The following tables set out the content of GCSE (9–1) in English Literature, Section A and Section B for component 01. These provide details on the required knowledge, understanding and skills as well as expected breadth and depth of texts studied.

Section A: Exploring modern and literary heritage texts (01)		
Text choice	Content	Learners should be able to:
Modern prose or drama Choice of one set text from: • <i>Anita and Me</i> – Meera Syal • <i>Never Let Me Go</i> – Kazuo Ishiguro • <i>Animal Farm</i> – George Orwell • <i>An Inspector Calls</i> – J. B. Priestley • <i>My Mother Said I Never Should</i> – Charlotte Keatley • <i>DNA</i> – Dennis Kelly.	Centres study one set text from the list, either prose or drama. Learners develop comprehension skills. Learners learn to articulate their understanding of aspects of plot, characterisation, events and settings and to distinguish between literal and implied meaning. Learners develop critical reading skills. Learners engage personally with texts, including with those written for performance and build confidence in their abilities to sustain an individual response which is supported and justified.	reflect critically and evaluatively on their reading. Learners are expected to respond to some of the following: • themes, ideas and issues • characters and relationships • language • social and/or cultural contextual factors. • pay attention to the details of a text: understanding the significance of a word, phrase or sentence in context • demonstrate the ability to read at a literal level and also explore deeper implications • explain motivation, sequence of events and the relationship between actions or events. • identify and interpret key themes • make an informed personal response, justifying a point of view by referring closely to evidence in the text • reflect critically and evaluatively on a text, using an understanding of context to inform reading

Text choice	Content	Learners should be able to:
Modern prose or drama	Learners reflect on the contexts in which texts are set, for example, those relating to social and cultural situations or experiences. Learners look at literary contexts in reading, for example, use of symbolism or allegory for effect. Learners develop their own viewpoints supported by textual evidence and recognising that there are different interpretations that other readers could make. Learners analyse and evaluate how language, form and structure inform and impact on their reading of texts. Learners will require knowledge and understanding of grammatical features and literary and linguistic terminology, including (but not restricted to), phrase, metaphor, meter, irony and persona in order to support their views about the text with insight and precision. Learners develop critical and comparative understanding of texts. Learners should explore modern literature more widely, through reading a diverse range of modern prose or drama extracts and texts. Learners engage with different texts and begin to discover how understanding of one text is illuminated by its relationship with another. This prepares them for making comparisons between their studied text (printed extract) and a thematically linked unseen modern, same-genre extract in the exam.	- recognise and evaluate the possibility of different valid responses to a text. - explain and illustrate how choice of language shapes meaning - analyse how the writer uses language, form and structure to create effects and impact - use relevant subject terminology accurately to support their views. - in order to enhance their understanding of themes, characters, settings, contexts (where known) and literary styles, learners make connections and contrasts between texts, comparing features and qualities.

Text choice	Content	Learners should be able to:
Modern prose or drama	Learners develop writing skills. Learners make a sustained, informed personal response to their reading. They are able to write effectively about literature for different purposes, including writing to describe, explain, summarise, argue, analyse and evaluate. Learners craft their writing and create impact through careful selection and emphasis of key points, interwoven with textual evidence to back up their understanding and ideas.	• produce clear and coherent pieces of extended writing • select and emphasise key points and ideas for a particular purpose • develop and maintain a consistent viewpoint • use textual references and quotations effectively to support views • use accurate Standard English and spelling, punctuation and grammar.